

DAROUB

Sir Bani Yas Island and Arabian Wildlife Park

A compact field guide

An Al Dhafra island reserve for operated wildlife drives and weather-dependent water activities; marker approximate, image illustrative.

Reference edition dated 2026-09-18

A concise Daroub guide based on the listed sources. The location is approximate, not a trailhead. Check current weather and local closures before leaving.

24.317, 52.604 | Asia/Dubai

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01 Place and terrain

Sir Bani Yas is an island reserve in Al Dhafra with the Arabian Wildlife Park at its centre. The marker is an approximate area marker, not a trailhead or jetty; the image is illustrative of coast terrain. Plan it as an operated visit, not open roaming, and check details on the day.

[Visit Abu Dhabi · Sir Bani Yas Island](#)

[Visit Abu Dhabi · Arabian Wildlife Park](#)

02 Equipment and preparation

Practical inference: carry your booking, suitable ID and offline operator instructions. For kayaking or snorkelling, ask what life jacket or equipment is provided before buying alternatives. Add personal water and sun protection, because shops and transfers on the island depend on your programme.

[Anantara · Kayaking in Abu Dhabi](#)

[Anantara · Desert Islands island discovery](#)

03 Clothing and footwear

General advice, not a local requirement: use light covering clothes, hat, sunglasses and stable footwear for leaving vehicles or cycling. For water activities, add quick-dry clothing and a dry layer for return, and follow the resort's changing arrangements.

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[Anantara · Desert Islands island discovery](#)

04 Access and transport

The wildlife park page describes road access to Sir Bani Yas jetty followed by a complimentary boat to the island. Arrange transfers with the resort or operator and do not use coordinates as final driving instructions. If sea state or schedule changes, boats or activities may change; check before leaving.

[Visit Abu Dhabi · Arabian Wildlife Park](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · ALBAHAR](#)

05 Season and conditions

The National Center of Meteorology provides warnings and a marine service, while island sources list outdoor and water activities. Planning should not rely on sunshine alone: wind or sea state may make kayaking or snorkelling unsuitable. Check warnings and forecasts on the visit day.

[Anantara · Desert Islands island discovery](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · ALBAHAR](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · Early Warnings for All](#)

06 Nature and identification limits

Sources record oryx, gazelles, cheetahs and giraffes, and mention waters around the island for turtles, dolphins and dugongs. The list here is documented examples, not a complete inventory or identification key. Observe from the guide's distance; do not feed or touch wildlife or marine life.

[Visit Abu Dhabi · Sir Bani Yas Island](#)

[Anantara · Kayaking in Abu Dhabi](#)

[Anantara · From extinction to the wild](#)

07 Visit precautions

Main hazards are planning-related: predators within a reserve, heat and exposure, and sea state that may be unsuitable despite clear skies. Practical inference: stay in the vehicle or with the guide, and stop when the operator says so. UAE emergencies: police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997.

[UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Anantara · Nature drive](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · ALBAHAR](#)

[National Center of Meteorology · Early Warnings for All](#)

08 Activity choice and booking

For a first visit, choose one well-booked activity: wildlife drive, calm kayaking, snorkelling when the sea is suitable, or a short bicycle outing. Sources confirm these options but not daily availability. Book, then reconfirm time, weather and participation conditions.

[Anantara · Nature drive](#)

[Anantara · Kayaking in Abu Dhabi](#)

[Anantara · Desert Islands island discovery](#)

09 Rules and permits

Wildlife access is through operated drives and authorised vehicles, not self-tracking animals. Abu Dhabi protected areas require respect for the environment and some open only by permit. Do not fly drones or collect organisms, corals or shells. Follow resort and marine conditions, and keep emergency numbers.

[UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies \(police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997\)](#)

[Anantara · Nature drive](#)

[Environment Agency Abu Dhabi · Experience Green Abu Dhabi](#)

[UAE Government portal · Life below water](#)

Wildlife & plants

Arabian oryx

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Sources document oryx in the wildlife park. This is broad recognition guidance and does not guarantee a sighting on any drive.

Observe only from the vehicle or with the guide; do not approach or feed it.

[Visit Abu Dhabi · Sir Bani Yas Island](#)

[Anantara · Nature drive](#)

Sand gazelle

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

The conservation page lists sand gazelles among island species. Visitors may confuse them with other antelope, so this is not a precise field key.

Keep distance and do not chase it for photographs or by bicycle.

[Anantara](#) · [From extinction to the wild](#)

Cheetah

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Sources mention cheetahs in the reserve and rewilding programme. A predator's presence is not an invitation to approach or a guaranteed sighting.

Follow guide and vehicle instructions; do not open doors or get out for a photo.

[Anantara](#) · [Nature drive](#)

[Anantara](#) · [From extinction to the wild](#)

Giraffe

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

Visit Abu Dhabi and the nature drive page record giraffes in the park. This is a possible sighting note, not a promise of place or timing.

Do not extend hands or food from the vehicle; photograph only from the distance set by the guide.

[Visit Abu Dhabi](#) · [Sir Bani Yas Island](#)

[Anantara](#) · [Nature drive](#)

Dugong

[Information linked to regional sources](#)

The kayaking page and conservation article mention dugongs in or around island waters. Marine visibility is condition-dependent and should not be assumed.

Do not pursue it by boat or paddle; leave routing to the operator and avoid touching marine life.

Anantara · Kayaking in Abu Dhabi

Anantara · From extinction to the wild

Jellyfish

Terrain example; not proof of presence at given coordinates

General coastal precaution example: the fetched sources did not document a specific local species, but water activities still require same-day condition checks.

Practical inference: ask the operator about stings or warnings before entering; leave the water if advised.

National Center of Meteorology · ALBAHAR

National Center of Meteorology · Early Warnings for All

Travel companions

A buddy-planning recommendation, not a safety guarantee. Remote or technical routes need group planning with a local expert. Avoid going alone.

Before you leave

Choose your route and turn-back point; check entry permissions and closures.

Check the forecast and save an offline map.

Review clothing, water, food and communication with your companions.

Agree a return time and alternative plan, and share them with a trusted contact.

Educational terrain examples, not a complete inventory or verified species list for these coordinates. Do not eat plants or animals based on this guide.

Sources and further reading

1. UAE Government portal · Handling emergencies (police 999, ambulance 998, civil defence 997)

<https://u.ae/en/information-and-services/justice-safety-and-the-law/Safety/handling-emergencies>

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2. Visit Abu Dhabi · Sir Bani Yas Island

<https://visitabudhabi.ae/en/where-to-go/islands/sir-bani-yas-island>

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3. Visit Abu Dhabi · Arabian Wildlife Park

<https://visitabudhabi.ae/en/things-to-do/nature-and-wildlife/wildlife/arabian-wildlife-park>

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4. Anantara · Nature drive

<https://www.anantara.com/en/desert-islands-sir-bani-yas/island-discovery/nature-drive>

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5. Anantara · Kayaking in Abu Dhabi

<https://www.anantara.com/en/al-yamm-sir-bani-yas/experiences/kayaking>

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6. Anantara · Desert Islands island discovery

<https://www.anantara.com/en/desert-islands-sir-bani-yas/island-discovery>

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7. Anantara · From extinction to the wild

<https://www.anantara.com/en/blog/from-extinction-to-the-wild>

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8. Environment Agency Abu Dhabi · Experience Green Abu Dhabi

<https://www.ead.gov.ae/en/experience-green-abu-dhabi>

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9. National Center of Meteorology · ALBAHAR

<https://albahar.ncm.gov.ae/>

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10. National Center of Meteorology · Early Warnings for All

<https://ew4all.ncm.gov.ae/?lang=en>

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11. UAE Government portal · Life below water

<https://u.ae/en/about-the-uae/leaving-no-one-behind/14lifebelowwater>

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Further guide from the official publisher

Arabian Wildlife Park - Sir Bani Yas Island

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